Ysbyty Gwynedd
Anaesthetics Department
Adran Anaestheteg

OPERATIONAL POLICIES AND GUIDELINES

YGAD OPG 001 V 1.3 JAN 2018.

Writing Local Guides

REVIEW BY DEC 19.

Author: Guideline Review Panel.

Key Points

- Keep your Local Guideline to 2 pages.
- Use the standard template.
- Make sure it is consistent with national guidelines and best practice.
- Include useful practical tips.
- Include a reference, version number, publication date, review date and author(s).
- Get it reviewed by a consultant with an interest in the subject.
- Send it to the Guideline Review Panel.

Writing a Local guide

1. Guidelines give general advice and recommendations for dealing with specific circumstances and therefore assist staff in making a decision about the appropriateness of an action. The key word is they are there to assist. They do not have to be followed verbatim, and there may well be circumstances when it is not appropriate to follow the guidelines.
2. Start off with defining exactly what your guideline is covering. If your subject is very broad (eg management of patients with medical problems) your guideline is going to be too long to be any use to anyone. Consider breaking down in different parts and have different guidelines for different issues.
3. Don't reinvent the wheel. See what other guidelines exist within the department (FRCA drive), hospital, health-board and beyond.
4. Make sure your guideline is up to date and consistent with latest published national guidelines (NICE, AAGBI, etc.) AAGBI and NICE are good starting places but do a quick literature search and use Uptodate® or other online resources. The BJA continuing education supplement is also useful.
5. Make sure the guide is relevant to our equipment and drugs, etc.
6. Write in plain English and summarise. Aim to keep the guideline to 2 pages. Keep to practical useful tips. This is an in-house departmental guideline, you are not writing for the whole of the NHS.
7. Use the standard template.
8. Use section headings (Heading 1).
9. Make sure you spell check and proof read.
10. Use Flowcharts and diagrams. Attach them in **jpg format**.

11. Summarise key points in the introduction.
12. Include useful phone numbers, links to web pages, references, online videos, etc. These will need to be all checked every year at the review however.
13. Include references to hospital, BCUHB, and national guidelines.
14. Include names of author at the top bar on the left.
15. Version Control: Guideline reference number and version number on the right. Start with version 1.0. After each edit the version number goes up by 0.1 (1.0 , 1.1 , 1.2, etc.) Once finalized the published version will be rounded up to the next whole (1.12 becomes 2.0).
16. In footer include email address of the reviewer.
17. Set a review date (month and year). Set for 12 monthly to begin with.